SYED KHIZAR RAYAZ

Senior AI & Machine Learning Engineer | Agentic AI, RAG, Fintech Backends

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

AI/ML Engineer with 3+ years delivering production AI for banking compliance (AML, GRC), payments and trading. Owner of 10 agentic-AI use cases for banks (3 production-ready), built on a strict doctrine: AI drafts, deterministic code decides, humans approve, every value hash-chain audited. Shipped two payment rails and an AI onboarding backend for a European fintech (~155 commits in 10 months). Python, FastAPI, LLM orchestration, Flutter, AWS/Docker/Kubernetes. MSc AI Engineering candidate at Istanbul Okan University.

CORE COMPETENCIES

AI/ML: Agentic AI (human-in-the-loop, deterministic fallbacks, audit trails), RAG & Semantic Search, LLM Routing (OpenAI, Claude, Gemini, OpenRouter, Ollama), Anomaly Detection, Computer Vision, OCR, PII Masking

Engineering: Python, FastAPI, Django, Node.js, Dart/Flutter, React/Next.js, Angular, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Kafka, OAuth2/JWT, mTLS

Cloud & MLOps: AWS (EC2, S3, ECS, Textract), Docker, Kubernetes, Jenkins, CI/CD, scikit-learn, PyTorch, TensorFlow/Keras, LangChain, ChromaDB

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Benchmatrix
Sep 2024 - Present

AI Engineer | GRC & AML Agentic-AI Programme for Banks

- Own 10 assigned AI use cases (8 operational-risk/GRC, 2 AML) in a bank-facing agentic-AI programme; AML alert prioritization, AI case summary and transaction network analysis are production-ready, and the ScanX operational-risk and Loss Data agents are demo-ready (Nov 2026).
- Built the Loss Data Analysis Agent end-to-end (FastAPI, MySQL 8, Angular 19, OAuth2/JWT with 3 roles): 8 build stages, ~45 endpoints, 56/56 tests, SHA-256 hash-chained evidence vault; ingests 482 controls, 201 risks, 3,408 risk-control maps and 80 KRIs; deployed on Kubernetes via Jenkins for a bank demo in Oct 2026.
- Trained and deployed the AML alert-prioritization model (Random Forest, 100 trees, imbalanced-learn pipeline) and a GenAI case-analysis service with an evaluator agent and optional JWT; cut false positives by 50% and gave analysts a structured investigation narrative per alert.
- Conducted senior code reviews of 3 agent codebases (KRI agent: 371 assertions; Control Breach agent: 127 checks incl. a 34-case golden harness; AML LLM-to-GBDT distillation pipeline) and documented 19 ranked findings with reproduced bugs before release.

OneMoneyWay
Nov 2025 - Present

AI Consultant | Freelance (European fintech: wallets, cards, payments)

- Delivered ~155 authored commits across 4 repositories in 10 months (core backend 76, AI backend 60+, CRM 9, admin panel 10), adding ~30.8k lines to the core banking backend with additive, legacy-safe changes.
- Built the greenfield AI onboarding backend: per-user email cadence automation, bank-statement OCR/RAG validation (rules engine + LLM advisory with PII masking), FCM push, Basic Auth and IP rate limiting, Dockerized to AWS ECS; onboarding completion doubled.
- Integrated two payment rails end-to-end: Treezor (wallets, cards, PCI mTLS, 3DS/SCA, WebAuthn) and Moonrise (accounts, ledger, local transfers with idempotency and locks, fee reconciliation); completed the CRM card-renewal and 3DS UI.

Microlinks (Pvt.) Ltd
Apr 2026 - Sep 2026

Software Engineer (Application Developer) | Freelance, part-time (PSX brokerage clients)

- Relaunched the FDM Securities brokerage website with live PSX data for 10 indices (live since Jul 2026), ported a ~40-screen React app to Flutter for StockBazar with a fully local CNIC/passport OCR service, and redesigned a white-label PSX trading app UI (6 broker builds) for Chase Securities.

Alpha AI Digital Solutions
Dec 2025 - Present

Software Engineer (Application Developer) | Freelance, part-time

- Built PriceWise end-to-end (React Native/Expo, Google Places, GPT-4 price prediction, Node API on DigitalOcean) and a CI/CD pipeline for RAIS that cut deployment time by 70%.

Meteoric Solutions
Jan 2024 - Aug 2024

Machine Learning Engineer | Part-time Consultant (Sep 2024 - Sep 2025)

- Led client AI projects from research to production and mentored a team of AI developers; RAG for Bank Alfalah (ChromaDB, OpenAI, Elasticsearch) improved sales response time by 40%.

EDUCATION

Istanbul Okan University, Istanbul
Sep 2026 - 2028 (expected)

MSc Artificial Intelligence Engineering (with Thesis, English) - Design of AI Systems, Image Processing, Decision Making & Robotics

University of Karachi (UBIT)
Jan 2020 - Dec 2023

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

CERTIFICATIONS

Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Certified Generative AI Professional · Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Certified AI Foundations Associate